

STARTUP REVENUE ANALYSIS

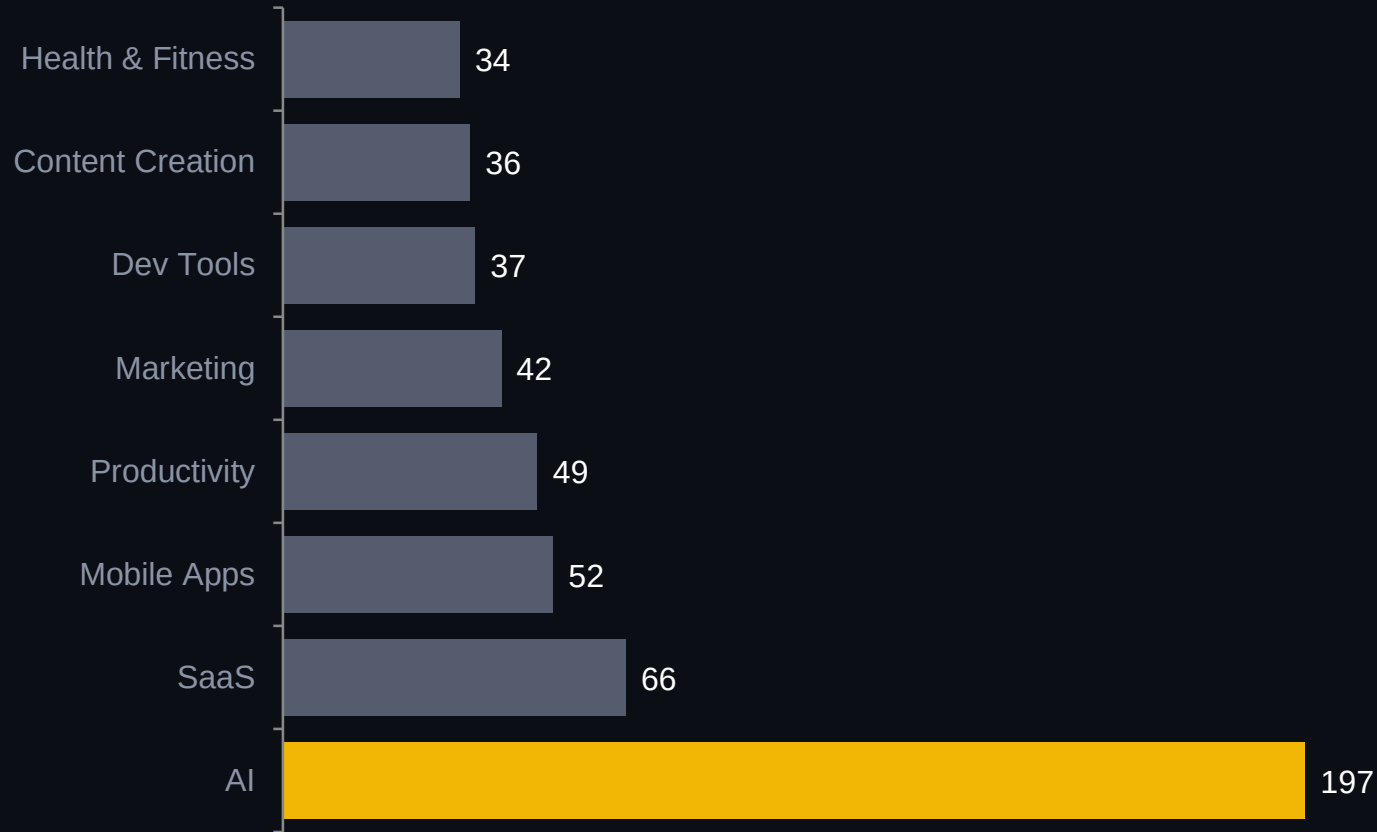
# AI IS CROWDED. THE MONEY ISN'T.

What 1,000 real startups' revenue says about the AI narrative

*Source: live revenue & pricing data, n = 1,000 startups across 65 countries*



# Every fifth startup calls itself “AI”



197

AI startups in the dataset —  
nearly 3x SaaS, the next-largest category

## 02 — THE HEADLINE VS. THE MEDIAN

**The average AI startup is growing.  
The typical one isn't.**

**76%**

**AVERAGE 30-DAY GROWTH**

*the number that makes headlines*

**0%**

**MEDIAN 30-DAY GROWTH**

*what the typical AI startup actually sees*

63% of AI startups saw flat or falling revenue last month — a small number of breakout winners are pulling the average up.

## 5 startups earn more than the other 192 combined

55%

Top 5 AI startups

45%

Remaining 192 AI startups

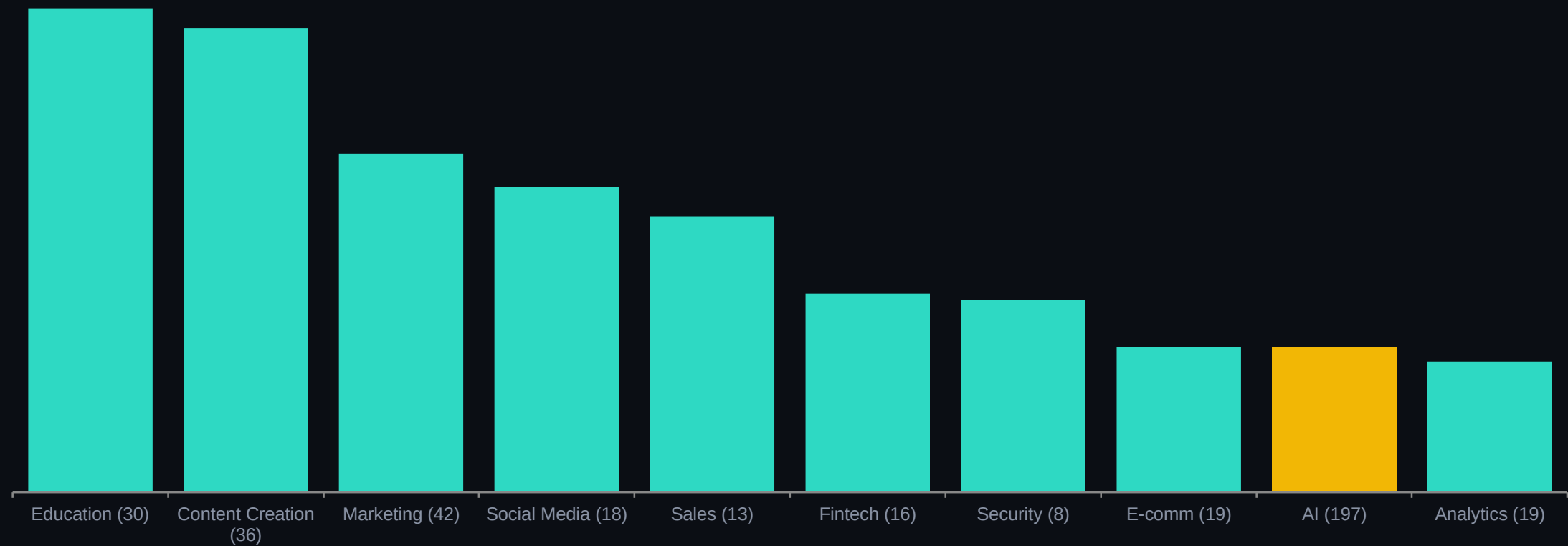
2.5%

of AI startups generate over half  
of all AI category revenue

*This is a power-law category: picking “AI” isn’t a thesis. Picking the outlier is.*

# AI ranks 9th of 21 categories in typical revenue

Median revenue per startup, category vs. category:



# The US doesn't just have volume — it has margin

Median revenue per startup by country:



*India has the 3rd-most startups in the dataset — and the lowest revenue per startup of any market at scale. Volume without pricing power looks the same everywhere.*

# Don't invest in the AI label. Invest in outliers.



## AI

A power-law category. Assume most bets go flat — underwrite for the 2.5% that carry it.

## QUIET CATEGORIES

Education & Content Creation post higher typical revenue with a fraction of the competition.

## GEOGRAPHY

US and Canada monetize best per founder — volume elsewhere hasn't yet become margin.



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SECTION B

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